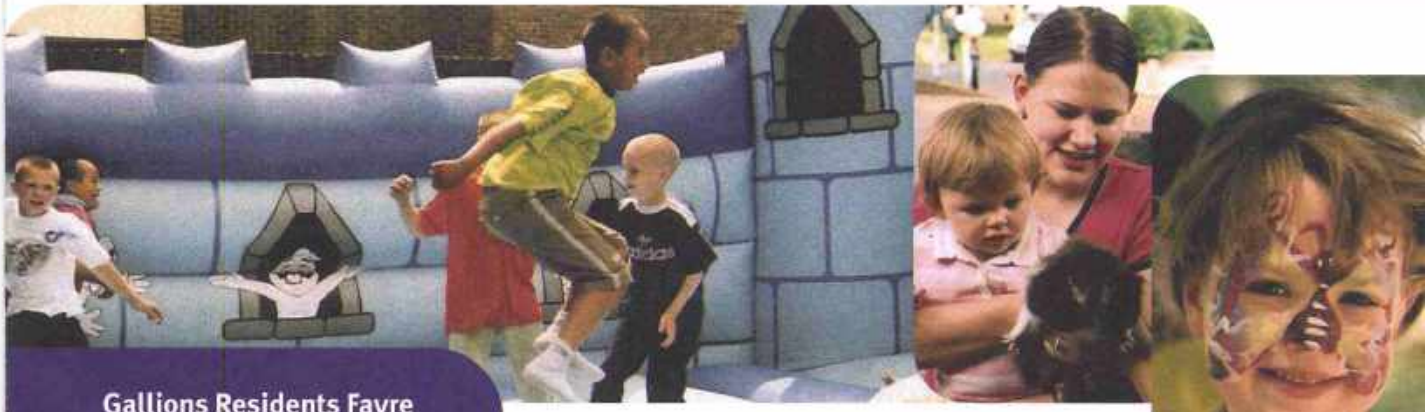
Tavy Bridge news

GALLIONS HOUSING ASSOCIATION

EDITION THREE SEPTEMBER 2002





Fun day update

The Tavy Bridge Fun day was a great success. All the local residents and shopkeepers were invited and over 250 people joined in the fun. Those attending had the opportunity to look at the proposals for Tavy Bridge and meet the architects developing the new design.

The Mayor of Bexley, Ann Lucas and her husband Councillor Richard Lucas attended the event. The New Business Director Nigel Parrington gave a short speech on the vision for Tavy Bridge while several members of the Community Renewal Team were on hand to discuss the new initiatives for the area.

Staff from local community groups also attended the event. The Four Legged Friends brought along some of their furry friends to show the children, while the volunteers from the Youth Awareness Project gave advice to the young people who attended.

Stilt walkers, magicians, face painters and the bouncy castle entertained the children while the glorious sunshine, food and drink kept the adults happy.

There was a positive response from the residents who commented on how nice it was that something was being done for the local children.

I would like to take this opportunity to say a big THANK YOU to Wendy and Brian Bradbury for all their help and support in orgainsing the fun day.

Kaye Sene
Community Renewal Assistant

Gallions Residents Fayre was held on Saturday 7th September. Over 800 people came along. There were fun events and lots of stalls – giving the opportunity to find out more about Gallions.

Drama Workshop



As you can see our summer workshop was great fun. Girls and Boys if you are aged between 5 and 11 years old and would like to the opportunity to join in the fun during the Autumn term break give Kaye a ring: 020 8320 3462.

Police update

79 cars from the Bexley side of Thamesmead were clamped and taken to the local car pound for not displaying tax discs. The project was carried out in conjunction with Bexley council, Bexley police and Gallions housing so that cars parked on the road or private land (i.e. land owned by Gallions) could be removed if they failed to display tax discs. Several cars were taken from the parking area of Tavy Bridge.

Garage burglaries have increased in the Binsey Walk/Tavy Bridge area. Please be vigilant and report suspicious persons or vehicles, particularly at night, to the police.

Finally – If a crime is being committed at the time then please ring 999 as opposed to the local number.

Quick Wins

Look out for work starting to the green area behind Tavy Bridge in the next month. The lighting will be improved, new seating and new bins will be installed and the general environment will be improved.

If you have any queries about these works, please contact Claire Irvine on **020 8320 3494.**

Homework Club

Are you interested in helping to set up a homework club in our Tenants Resource Centre for secondary school children?

The Resource centre offers seven computers with access to the following software: Publisher, Excel Word, Access and two of the computers offer Internet access. There is also use of the printer, binder, photocopier and laminator in a quiet, secure environment. The perfect place to work on your GCSE course work.

We are hoping to pilot the scheme in September opening on Wednesday evenings from 4pm until 6pm and Saturday mornings from 10 – 12noon.

If you are interested in this scheme or have any comments you would like to make please contact **Kaye Sene** on **020 8320 3462**

The Community Chest *is now up and running*

The Community Chest is a fund which offers small grants to Gallions Housing Association residents for community based initiatives. Applications can come from recognised Tenants or Residents Associations, or from local residents who have a initiative they would like to run for the benefit of their local community.



If you are interested in applying please contact **Kaye Sene** on **020 8320 3462** and she will send out the relevant information.

Black History Month...

...will be represented in Thamesmead with a 3-day event at Emmanuel Church in Yarnton Way on the 17th 18th 19th October.

Events will include the famous **Umoja** fresh from the West End who will be performing for local primary schools as well as food, exhibitions, DJ/MC/Dance performances, stalls and workshops. As part of the National Black History month, it is an event that is open to the whole community.

The event is being planned by Thamesmead Youth Awareness Programme.

For further details contact:
Norma Mthethwa on **020 8311 5111**
or email tyap@in-volve.org.uk.

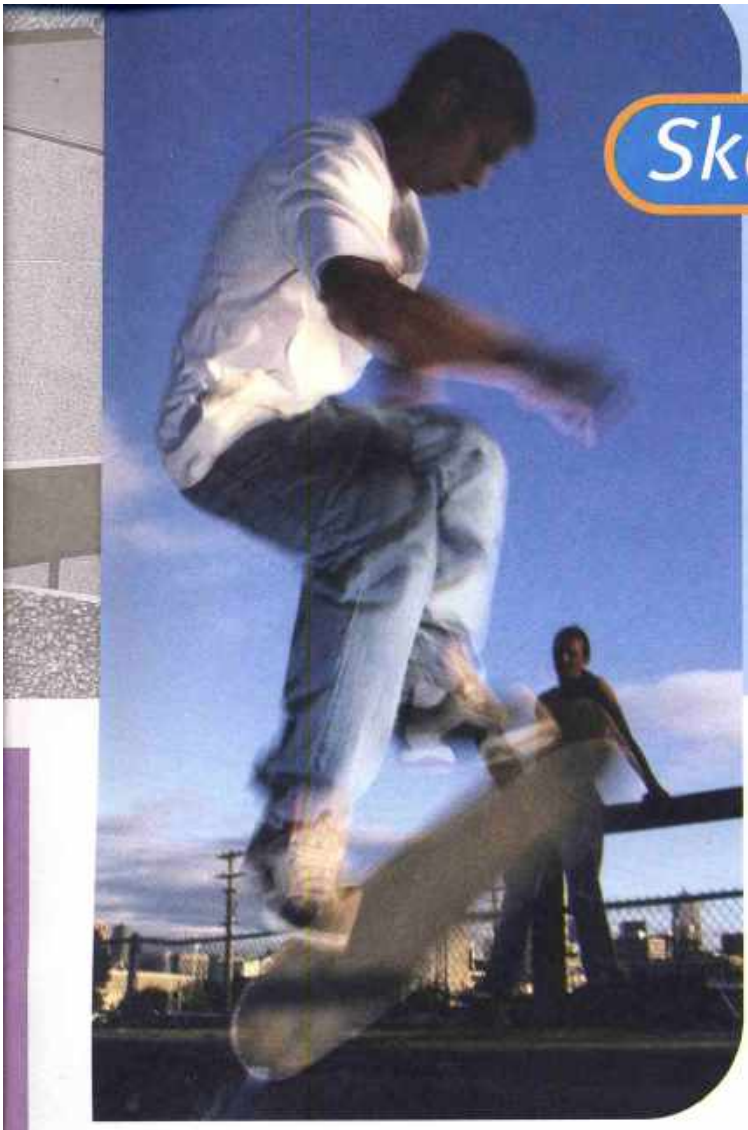
Did you know?

Tenants and residents who park untaxed motor vehicles on Gallions land are in breach of their tenancy agreement and Gallions have given the relevant agencies permission to remove such cars.

Library Closure

The Thamesmead Library in Binsey Walk will be closed from the 30th September for approximately one month to under go some refurbishment works.

For further information on the closure of the library please phone **020 8310 9944**



Skateboard Park update

We carried out a quick survey at the Tavy Bridge Fun day to find out if you thought the Skateboard Park is a good idea. The results were a definite yes!

If you are interested in joining a forum or passing on your ideas give me a ring on **020 8320 3462.** We want to involve as many local young people as we can to make sure we deliver the right kind of park for you!

So get in contact and let's make it happen!



Hello, my name is Sam Weaver and I am the new Community Renewal Co-ordinator. I am part of the Community Renewal Team and I am working on a wide range of projects which will support tenants, residents and local enterprises in the Thamesmead area.

At the moment I am working with a group of residents to clean up Southmere Lake and improve conditions for the local wildlife. There are ways for both adults and children to get involved.

If you have any ideas, would like further information or would like to get involved in this project, please give me a ring on 020 8320 3418.

Hope to hear from you soon,

Sam Weaver

Audio X...

YAP in partnership with Gallions Housing and Trust Thamesmead are launching an exciting music technology project in September for young people living in Thamesmead and Abbey Wood.

Using the latest technology and software you will be able to produce CD quality beats, loops and samples which can be pressed up onto vinyl and demos.

We want to uncover the talent in the neighbourhood which we know is there. There will be recording studio facilities, 12 iMac computers running Cubase, Reason, Recycle and Sparkle software.

On top of all this is the opportunity to gain a free music technology LOCN qualification.

Audio X will be run from the brand new Audio Lounge at YAP.

c/o Gallions Harrow Manorway SE2 9XH

Ring **Amina Begum** or **Lisa Nicholls** for registration but hurry as places are limited! **0208 311 5111**

Please note. In the last edition of the newsletter there was a misprint concerning the numbers to contact PC Rob Evans. The numbers should read:
020 8284 5528 or 020 8284 5529.
We would like to apologise for any problems or inconvenience this may have caused.



Did you know?

There are four nesting pairs of swans who laid 21 eggs. 8 cygnets hatched but only one has survived.

Normally 40-50 young coots survive each year, but this year there are only 5. Out of 29 young mallards which hatched this year, none have survived and 2 out of 6 Great Crested Grebes have survived.

Canada Geese are the only birds to flourish this year – this is because they stick together in groups for protection.

If you don't want to get actively involved in the 'Clean Up' operations there are still ways you can help to look after your lake and give the birds a fighting chance for next year:

- Please use the litter bins to reduce litter in the area – please be especially careful not to leave the plastic rings from four packs of beer lying around as birds can get stuck in these. We will be putting some more bins along the Eastern grass bank so you do not have so far to walk.
- If you take you dog for a walk round the lake, please ensure that they don't chase the birds.
- If you fish, please follow the regulations below to ensure that you cause as little harm as possible to the fish and other wildlife in and around the lake.

Regulation Notice for Southmere Lake Fishing

All fishing regulations and conditions written or otherwise must be adhered to and permits may be cancelled for non-compliance.

1. Fishing is permitted from the Western Grass Bank only excluding the conservation area.
2. All anglers over 12 years of age must hold a current NRA rod licence and a current Thamesmead fishing permit, available for inspection at all times. Permits are not transferable.
3. Duty staff have the right to suspend fishing at any time, for mis-use or damage to swims etc.
4. No keepnets are allowed; all fish must be returned immediately to the water with the least possible injury.
5. Do not cast when wild fowl are in the vicinity.
6. Do not discard line, tackle, litter or any debris. Anglers are asked to keep their swims clear of litter etc.
7. Only barbless hooks may be used in Thamesmead waters.
8. No bank fires or music is allowed.
9. Anglers may only fish from authorised areas.
10. No fishing is allowed from any boat or craft.
11. All noise must be kept to the minimum at all times.
12. The following are not permitted:
    a) Dead lines set lines, net fishing, foul hooking, spearing and snarling. No more than two rods to be used at any one time and shall not be more than 6 ft apart.
    b) The use of lead shot.
    c) Leaving rods unattended baited or not.
    d) for pike with any device or tackle, which causes the pike to be taken or returned to the water with serious injury.
    e) Using hemp seed or ground bait.
    f) The use of bright lights and camping lanterns (Gaz or Tilley etc). A hand torch is allowed providing it causes no annoyance to other Anglers.

Claire Irvine has been seconded to the Tavy Bridge Project for the next 12 months. Her role will be to plan this complex project, consult with residents and organisations and attract funding support for the proposals.

A consultation document has been produced which details the redevelopment proposals and the key aims of the project.

Claire has experience of working on regeneration schemes in other parts of London and has been working with residents living at Tavy Bridge for one year. If you would like to speak to Claire about the regeneration of Tavy Bridge or would like a copy of the consultation document please contact her on **020 8320 3494** or email on **cirvine@gallionsha.co.uk**



"I am looking forward to working with residents, local groups and organisations to make sure that our plans for Tavy Bridge become reality."

This newsletter is produced by Gallions Housing Association.